

Christopher Walker

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Personal Statement

Pragmatic Junior AI Researcher (3 years in Data/AI/ML). I enjoy untangling messy systems and leaving them simpler than I found them. Day to day that means Snowflake, Kafka and a lot of conversations with the people who use what we build.

Academic Background

Master, Economics

Lake Thomas National University | 2019 to 2021

Thesis: "Labour mobility and remote work adoption"

Bachelor, Economics

Westtown State University | 2019

Experience

Junior AI Researcher, Airbnb

March 2022 to January 2026 | West Roy

- Cut inference cost by 15% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Terraform.
- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on Hugging Face, cutting retraining from days to 10 hours.
- Developed an NLP classification system in Spark reaching 88% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.

Projects

Charity chatbot

Built a Snowflake assistant for a local charity to answer volunteer questions; retired it once they moved to a supported platform.

Professional Certifications

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) — Scrum Alliance, 2017

Tableau Desktop Specialist — Tableau, 2023

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2018

Selected Publications

"Demand elasticity in subscription markets" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2021.

"Labour mobility and remote work adoption" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2022.